of confidence in the government by the public. Therefore, it is about time that the government consider solving the land grabbing issues between farmers and private entrepreneurs" (Amyotha Hluttaw 2011). His speech truly reflected what had been happening on the ground as business firms' thirst for land increased.

The government was defensive on the issue, but promised to tackle it. The legislature decided to get involved strongly and formed an investigation commission on land grabbing when one of the Union Solidarity and Development Party (USDP) leaders took the initiative. U Tin Htut, chairman of the Farmers, Workers and Youth Affairs Committee of the Pyithu Hluttaw, raised a motion after receiving petitions from farmers (Pyidaungsu Hluttaw 2012). The legislature was non-partisan and it received a lot of attention with forty-six legislators debating the issue. A number of lawmakers took a proactive approach, liaising for their constituencies, while other lawmakers were passive and relied entirely on the commission.[3] The commission report was submitted to the president in seven parts from September 2013 to September 2014 (President's Office 2014b).

On 16 September 2013, soon after the submission of the first report on 20 August 2013, the president formed a Central Committee on Land Administration led by the Vice President Nyan Tun to solve land-grabbing issues. Public media was heavily involved in amplifying grievances. The issue received national attention on 4 February 2014 when police forcibly removed more than 1,000 families of Thamee Kalay village from Hlegu township in Yangon region because they resided on land owned by the military (DVB 2014). With mounting land-grabbing conflict, the Hluttaw investigation commission on land grabbing tabled a motion on 20 February 2014. Afterwards, the Speaker Thura U Shwe Mann urged the president to intervene and set a deadline to solve the crisis before the harvest season ended in September 2014 (Pyidaungsu Hluttaw 2014). The president responded immediately by requesting the legislators to cooperate with the Central Committee on Land Administration in order to solve the crisis effectively, and to be aware of the real situation rather than constantly pressuring the executive. Subsequently, on 30 April 2014, the president gave an interim report to the Hluttaw, claiming the government was doing its best to solve the land-grabbing crisis (President's Office 2014b), followed by opening of land administration offices across the country. On 19 December 2014, the government announced the status of almost